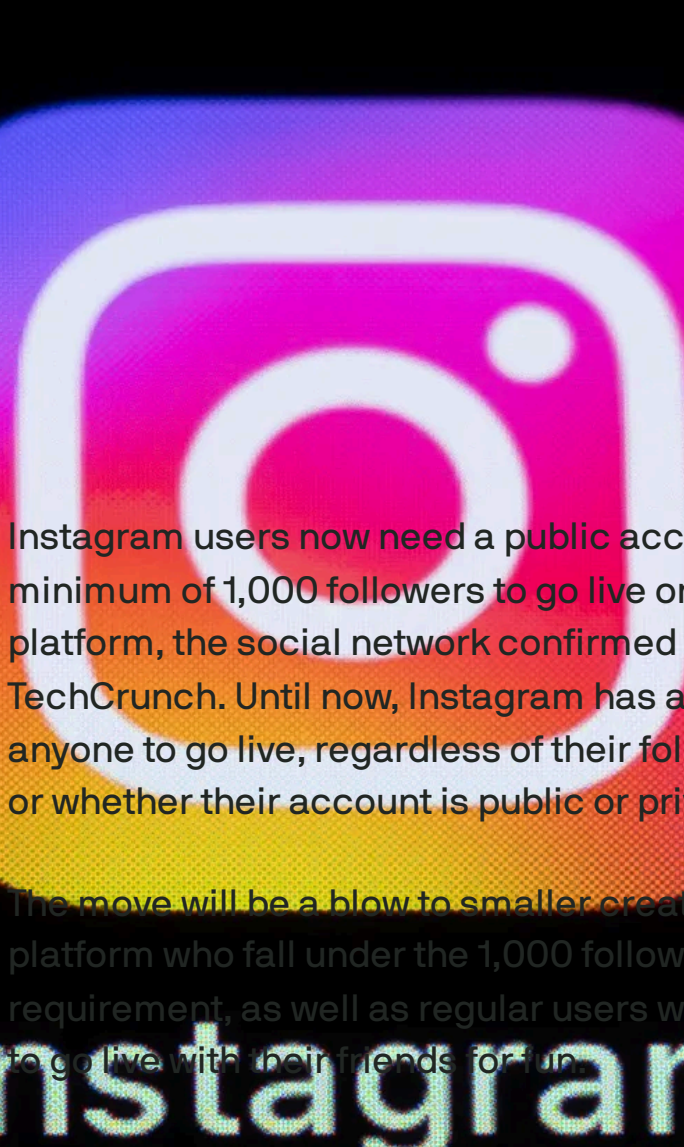


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Instagram now requires
users to have at least
1,000 followers to go live



Instagram users now need a public account with a minimum of 1,000 followers to go live on the platform, the social network confirmed to TechCrunch. Until now, Instagram has allowed anyone to go live, regardless of their follower count or whether their account is public or private.

The move will be a blow to smaller creators on the platform who fall under the 1,000 followers requirement, as well as regular users who just liked to go live with their friends for fun.

Users who don't have public accounts and have fewer than 1,000 followers will see [a new notice](#) when they try to go live, stating that their account is no longer eligible for Live. The notice continues, "We changed requirements to use this feature. Only public accounts with 1,000 followers or more will be able to create live videos."

Users have [taken to social media](#) to [express their displeasure](#) with [the change](#), with [some asking](#) for it to be reversed.

The change brings Instagram's live feature more in line with TikTok's, as the short-form video app also requires users to have at least 1,000 followers to go live. In comparison, YouTube requires channels to have a minimum of 50 subscribers to go live.

While the company didn't provide a specific reason for the change, it noted that the move is designed to improve the overall Live consumption experience.

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The change could limit lower-quality streams by only allowing users with an established audience to go live.

It could also be a way for Meta to save money. Since hosting livestreams is expensive, Meta may have decided that it doesn't want to support broadcasts with only a handful of viewers.

Topics: [Apps](#) [Instagram](#) [Social](#) [TikTok](#)



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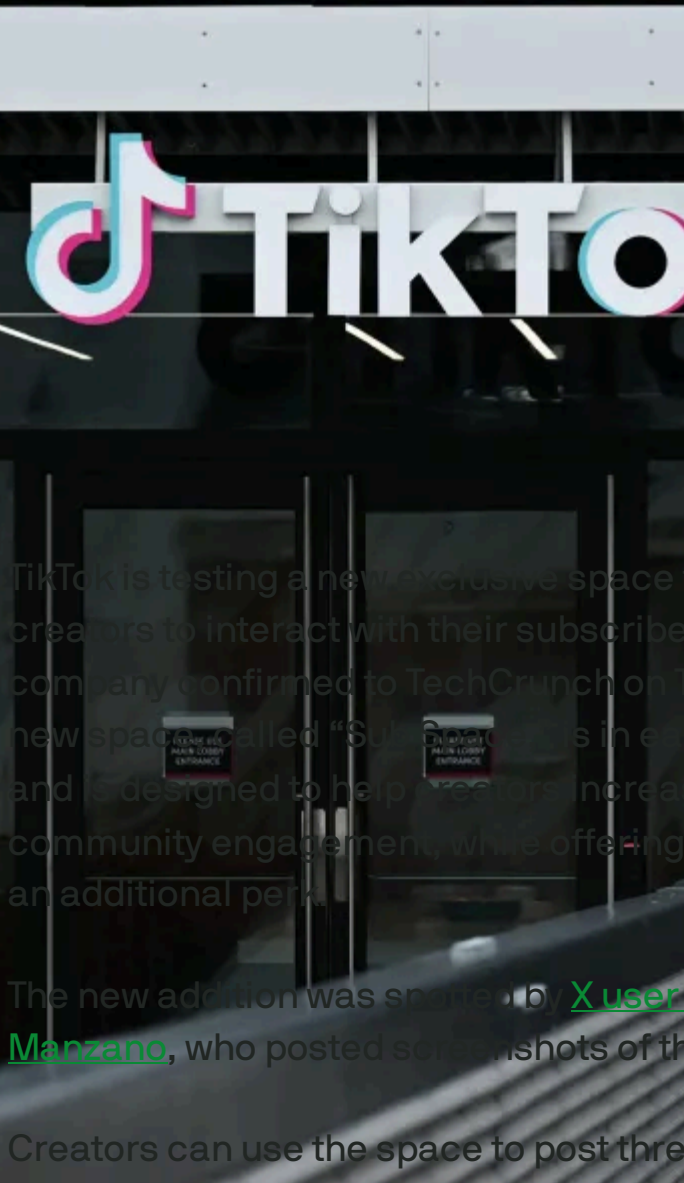
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TikTok is testing an exclusive 'Sub Space' where LIVE creators can interact with subscribers



Aisha Malik — 12:17 PM PST · February 13, 2024

TikTok is testing a new exclusive space for LIVE creators to interact with their subscribers, the company confirmed to TechCrunch on Tuesday. The new space, called “Sub Space,” is in early testing and is designed to help creators increase their community engagement, while offering subscribers an additional perk.

The new addition was spotted by [X user Jonah Manzano](#), who posted screenshots of the feature.

Creators can use the space to post threads with a topic and create polls to chat and interact with their subscribers. Although LIVE creators can already interact with viewers through chats during livestreams, the new offering is a way for creators to converse directly with paying subscribers. The new addition could entice regular viewers to sign up for a subscription in order to get exclusive access to streamers.

The screenshots show that creators can start conversation threads with their subscribers about different topics. They can choose to create a thread based on a suggested topic or write their own. For instance, they can ask their subscribers to introduce themselves, ask questions or share their first impressions of them all in different threads.

(NEW) TikTok is introducing a feature called Sub Space, where you can simply post threads with a

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— Jonah Manzano (@jonah_manzano) [February 6, 2024](#)

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The space can also be used as a way for creators to share snippets and updates about their lives with their subscribers, in a way that’s similar to [Instagram’s Broadcast Channels](#). Creators can also have a thread dedicated to their LIVE schedules to

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keep subscribers updated about their upcoming streams.

Plus, the polls option can be used for things like soliciting your subscribers' opinions on what type of streams they would like to see more of, or what time a majority of them would prefer for an upcoming stream.

TikTok has already offered creators subscriber-only perks, like subscriber-only videos or streams, but the new Sub Space gives creators a new direct way to interact with their subscribers. It gives them the chance to gain more subscribers by offering paying users access to exclusive content and interactions.

The new feature comes as TikTok has been looking to build out its LIVE offerings and potentially take on Twitch by appealing to gaming creators. Earlier this year, the company began piloting a program that opens up LIVE Studio, its desktop streaming software, to gaming creators who have fewer than 1,000 followers if they have a stable livestreaming history on another platform like Twitch. Prior to this pilot, gaming creators could only get access to LIVE Studio if they had a minimum of 1,000 followers. The pilot, however, lets you access the software and go live with fewer than 1,000 followers if you already have an established livestreaming history.

TikTok told TechCrunch that it wasn't promoting the pilot publicly, but said that a set number of gaming creators would be granted access to the pilot. The pilot could be a way for TikTok to lure gaming creators who are popular on Twitch and YouTube to consider going live on TikTok if they haven't already done so.

Kids spent 60% more time on TikTok than YouTube last year, 20% tried OpenAI's ChatGPT



No wonder YouTube launched Shorts. A new study of children's online habits found that children ages 4 through 18 spent a global average of 112 minutes daily on TikTok's short video app in 2023, an increase from 107 minutes the year prior. And although YouTube remains the world's biggest streaming app among this demographic, kids ... Continue reading

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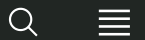
Instagram rolls out a new profile banner to display

users' upcoming live streams

Aisha Malik — 1:46 PM PST · January 26, 2022

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followers about upcoming Lives through a post or Story. With this new feature, Instagram is launching a dedicated way for users to notify others about scheduled Lives. The badge won't only be visible to your followers, but also to anyone else who may come across your profile, which could attract more viewers.

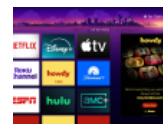
New Features

Some fun ones this week:

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Let me know what other features you'd like to see

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— Adam Mosseri (@mosseri) [January 26, 2022](#)

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Instagram's Live feature has become a key part of the app, especially for creators on the platform who use the tool as a way to directly engage with their followers. The company has been fine-tuning the feature to take on competitors like Clubhouse, Facebook and TikTok. Instagram has added several functionalities to Lives, such as the option to [mute](#)

[and turn off video](#) and the ability to [broadcast with up to four creators](#). Although it's a small change, Instagram's new profile banners for scheduled Lives could help creators get additional exposure and reach more users on the app.

[5 growth marketing predictions for 2022](#)

In the same video, Mosseri also outlined that users can now remix any video content on the app, which is a change that Instagram [announced](#) a few days ago. The company [officially launched Remix](#), which is its version of TikTok Duets, in March 2021. The feature lets users record their Reels video alongside a video from another user. Up until now, you could only remix short-form Reels. Now, you can remix any public video on the app. But this only applies to videos published publicly from this point forward, as the feature won't work on older content.

In addition to these new features, Instagram also recently [launched an early test](#) of creator subscriptions in the United States. Select creators are now able to offer their followers paid access to exclusive Instagram Live videos and Stories. Creators can choose their own price point for access to their exclusive content. Paid subscribers will be marked with a special badge, differentiating them from unpaid users in the sea of comments. Instagram isn't the only social media platform looking to experiment with subscriptions, as TikTok has also confirmed that it's [testing support](#) for paid subscriptions.

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Meta lures TikTok creators with \$5K bonuses, content deals, free verification

Aisha Malik — 10:36 AM PST · January 21, 2025

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Meta is luring TikTok creators over to its platforms with the promise of cash bonuses, content deals,

and support to grow their communities. The company announced on Tuesday that eligible TikTok creators will be able to earn “up to” \$5,000 in bonuses over three months for posting Reels on Facebook and Instagram.

These creators will also get access to the Facebook Content Monetization program, which allows creators to earn money for their videos, photos, and text posts on Facebook. Additionally, Meta will offer some TikTok creators content deals to help grow their audiences on Instagram and Facebook.

Some TikTok creators will also get a one-year trial of Meta Verified, which includes a verified badge, account support, and impersonation protection. (The company did not share the criteria for whose will receive access).

While TikTok is [back online in the U.S.](#) after going dark for 12 hours over the weekend, the ByteDance-owned social network is still missing from app stores. Although President Donald Trump [signed an executive order](#) on Monday to delay the TikTok ban deadline by 75 days and told the Department of Justice not to enforce the ban’s penalties, it’s unknown when (or if) the app will return to Apple and Google’s app stores.

Meta is clearly taking advantage of TikTok’s current troubles by poaching and attracting some of the service’s creators.

The company also said it’s rolling out changes to Reels to make the short-form video format more appealing to TikTok creators. For instance, U.S.-based Instagram creators can now publish Reels up to three minutes long, a notable increase from the previous 90-second limit. On TikTok, however, creators can record videos up to 10 minutes long, and in some cases, upload content [up to an hour](#) in length.

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In addition, Meta is going to make Reels more prominent, as the company plans to recommend Reels in more places across Instagram in Facebook. For instance, people may start to see recommended Reels higher up in their home feed. Plus, they may see more reels in their search results.

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To further court TikTok creators, Meta notes that it has optimized its ranking systems to allow newer creators to break through to new audiences.

Meta will also allow creators to show their Instagram, TikTok, or YouTube handles and follower counts in their Facebook profiles to boost their credibility on its platform.

Meta already made other changes to take advantage of TikTok’s current uncertainty in the U.S.

On Sunday, Meta revealed that it’s going to launch a [CapCut-like app called Edits](#) next month. On Friday, it [introduced updates](#) to make it easier for Instagram users to find Reels that their friends and followers are liking on the platform. The app will also encourage users to start conversations about Reels through a new “reply bar.”

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